

"ALL WAS WELL": *HARRY POTTER* IN THE MEDIEVALIST TRADITION

by

HANNAH MELENEY WILKES

ALEXANDRA COOK, COMMITTEE CHAIR

ALBERT PIONKE

KRISTEN WARNER

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ABSTRACT

Going beyond the obvious visual medievalisms — such as Hogwarts Castle and its sundry suits of armor — in J.K. Rowling's *Harry Potter* series and instead examining textual medievalisms — those plot points with precedents in medieval literature — I argue that *Harry Potter* is part of the tradition of medievalist literature. The tradition began as early as the sixteenth century but had its heyday in the nineteenth century, when it arose as a reaction to cultural nostalgia inspired by industrialization, and this nostalgia became an integral part of the tradition. The nostalgia to which Rowling responds, I argue, is a reaction to the politics of post-World War II Britain. The series recreates World War II but with a more positive ending, an ending that is possible because of Harry's visions in *Order of the Phoenix* and *Deathly Hallows* and others' memories, viewed in the Pensieve in *Half-Blood Prince* and *Deathly Hallows*.

I argue that these visions and memories are medievalisms because of their parallels to Geoffrey Chaucer's three major dream visions, the *Book of the Duchess*, the *House of Fame*, and the *Parliament of Fowls*, and because they can be read in the terms established by Macrobius in his *Commentary on the Dream of Scipio*. By using these medievalisms to create an ending that appeals to cultural nostalgia, I argue that Rowling has inserted her text into the tradition of medievalist literature.

My understanding of cultural nostalgia's role in medievalism has been largely shaped by Alice Chandler's *A Dream of Order*; my understanding of cultural nostalgia in modern Europe

comes, in part, from Malcolm Chase and Christopher Shaw's article "The Dimensions of Nostalgia" in their collection *The Imagined Past: History and Nostalgia*. My definition of medievalism comes from Kathleen J. Verduin's article "The Founding and the Founder: Medievalism and the Legacy of Leslie J. Workman," which reflects on Workman's efforts to establish medievalism as a field of study.

LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS

<i>BoD</i>	Chaucer's <i>Book of the Duchess</i>
<i>CoS</i>	Rowling's <i>Harry Potter and the Chamber of Secrets</i>
<i>DH</i>	Rowling's <i>Harry Potter and the Deathly Hallows</i>
<i>GoF</i>	Rowling's <i>Harry Potter and the Goblet of Fire</i>
<i>HBP</i>	Rowling's <i>Harry Potter and the Half-Blood Prince</i>
<i>HoF</i>	Chaucer's <i>House of Fame</i>
<i>OotP</i>	Rowling's <i>Harry Potter and the Order of the Phoenix</i>
<i>PoA</i>	Rowling's <i>Harry Potter and the Prisoner of Azkaban</i>
<i>PoF</i>	Chaucer's <i>Parliament of Fowls</i>
<i>SS</i>	Rowling's <i>Harry Potter and the Sorcerer's Stone</i>

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INTRODUCTION

Last fall, I was interviewed for an article about *Harry Potter* in the University of South Alabama's student newspaper, the *Vanguard*. One of the questions was, "Do you consider the *Harry Potter* series literature? Why or why not?" I answered that I absolutely consider the series literature because of its ability to instruct readers. I referred to the issues of race and class and the complicated ways in which Rowling addresses these modern social concerns. I would now add the idea that, in using medievalisms to appeal to cultural nostalgia, Rowling is instructing her adult audience. In an interview on the special edition *Chamber of Secrets* DVD, Rowling talks about race, explaining that the pure-bloods versus half-bloods and Muggle-borns theme, which arises in that book and remains crucial to the series, is a conscious metaphor for racism in our world. Rowling intends to instruct children through this metaphor. She admits that they may not recognize the issue of race in the books, but she hopes they will understand the message that we should value people for who they are, not what they are.

In reacting to cultural nostalgia¹, Rowling has made her books an instrument of instruction for adults. In this, I suggest that the series does what William Safire argues it cannot. In January 2000, Safire published an Op-Ed column in the *New York Times* despairing of adults' love of the series. He concedes that some children's literature is also appropriate adult fare. The novels that he claims meet this qualification do so because they are not necessarily only for

¹ By "cultural nostalgia," I mean a societal sense that the present is deficient. This sense leads to a romanticized vision of a time in history no one living can remember — in this thesis, the Middle Ages. The romanticized vision misremembers that past as a highly idealized time.

children or only for adults. *Harry Potter*, he claims, is not for adults because it "is not written on two levels, entertaining one generation while instructing another." Safire's argument, however, is incorrect. *Harry Potter*, through nostalgic appeals, tells adults how to react to the problems of the present. They can wonder "what if?," taking comfort in the idea that the past could have been different and maybe the future can be, too.

Farah Mendelsohn argues that Rowling engages with ideology unconsciously (159). Interviews with Rowling, however, clearly prove that she intends to teach moral and ideological lessons in the series. Melissa Anelli, widely regarded as an expert on the series, interviewed Rowling shortly after the latter announced that Dumbledore is gay. Anelli asked Rowling "whether homosexuality had the same taboo in her [the Wizarding] world that it did in the Muggle one." Rowling replied, "Inasmuch as it's something else someone like Malfoy would use against you" (327). This exchange indicates that Rowling has intentionally constructed a world in which ideology operates. If Malfoy could use homosexuality against someone, then there is some level of societal disapproval of homosexuality. Since Rowling created the Wizarding world, she intentionally created the ideology in which there are similar taboos between that world and ours. Rowling also considered ideology when trying to make societal points in *Deathly Hallows*: "I hated killing Lupin and Tonks. Hated it. But I was writing about war. That's what war does. It leaves little, newborn babies who never know..." (Anelli 329). Class is an issue in the books, as well. In making the Weasleys particularly noble and kind² and the Malfoys particularly evil, Rowling shows the poor family to be better than the wealthy family.

² Gail Orgelfinger discusses this in an interesting way. She draws parallels between Rowling's animal characters and medieval bestiaries. In both texts, the basilisk is an enemy of Christ and Christians, represented by the lion (Harry is effectively resurrected at the end of *Deathly Hallows*; Gryffindor House is represented by a lion. That it can destroy the lion makes the basilisk a representation of extreme moral failing. The weasel, though, can defeat it, which shows its superior goodness (142). The Weasleys' surname, of course, is a play on the word weasel. This is reinforced by Arthur Weasley's Patronus, which is a weasel.

As no real-world issue is clearly black and white, though, neither does *Harry Potter* have absolute good and evil. There are evil, good, and morally ambiguous pure-bloods, such as the sisters Bellatrix Lestrange, a Death Eater; Andromeda Tonks, an Order member; and Narcissa Malfoy, who is married to a Death Eater but, in the end, cares only for Draco's safety. The same is true of half-bloods. Harry and Voldemort are obvious examples of good and bad half-bloods, respectively. Snape, perhaps the most morally ambiguous character throughout the series, is also half-blood, the title character of *Half-Blood Prince*. In the end, readers learn that he strove only to protect Harry. In the process, though, he not only caused Harry great emotional turmoil but also allowed at least one innocent person, Charity Burbage, to be murdered. Rowling added another modern concern when she "outed" Dumbledore, saying in a 2007 interview that the headmaster is gay. What makes this particularly interesting is that Rowling has also said Dumbledore speaks for her. In making Dumbledore gay, Rowling projects her modern ideas onto this medievalist text in a very forceful way. Although modern readers may view homosexuality as immoral, they are forced to receive the author's moral injunctions through a homosexual character.

The *Vanguard* interview discussed *Harry Potter* simply as popular literature, but — as my writing this thesis indicates — I argue that the text is not only literature for the masses; it is literature for the academy. As he strove to establish medievalism as a field of study, Leslie J. Workman admitted that not all medievalists would welcome the study. Undoubtedly this is the case, but studying medievalism has nonetheless taken hold. Three recent editions of *Studies in Medievalism* — *Defining Medievalism(s)*, *Defining Medievalism(s) II*, and *Defining Neo-Medievalism(s)* — address a problem in discussing medievalism: definition. The definition I use

in this project³ is only one of many. Because it includes the words "conscious or unconscious," it expands the number of texts that can be analyzed in a discussion of medievalism. Widening the definition, perhaps, is not a move some scholars would condone. I applaud the wider definition because I find audience's engagement with the Middle Ages — whether they recognize it or not — significant. Within and outside of the academy, it is important to realize that medieval history and literature continue to influence popular culture. Cultural nostalgia, seen in Chaucer's poetry and integral to the medieval revival of the nineteenth century, remains today. The presence of this discontent creates a space in popular culture for texts like *Harry Potter* to make medievalism appealing.

In this thesis, I argue that Rowling responds to discontent created by the politics of post-World War II Britain. The *Harry Potter* series recreates World War II, making the ending a clearer victory for Britain. This ending is possible because of Harry's visions and others' memories, which allow Harry to defeat Voldemort. Because of parallels to Chaucer's dream visions, I argue that the visions and memories are medievalisms. The visions are medievalisms because Harry is always distressed before dreaming or experiencing a vision, as Chaucer's narrators are before falling asleep. Also, like medieval dream visions, Harry's dreams and semi-conscious visions fit into one of Macrobius' five categories of dreams, laid out in his *Commentary on the Dream of Scipio*. The memories are medievalisms because Chaucer's dream visions are memories and because personal nostalgia plays a role in the series' memories, as it does in Chaucer's visions. Both phenomena, the visions and memories, are medievalisms because their relationship to temporality is the same as Chaucer's visions'. By using medievalisms to

³ By "medievalism," I mean one of Workman's formulations: "any engagement with the Middle Ages, conscious or unconscious." I discuss this definition in more detail at the beginning of Chapter Three.

create an ending that responds to cultural nostalgia, I argue, Rowling has made the *Harry Potter* series part of the tradition of medievalist literature.

I begin the body of this thesis by discussing the critical reception of the series, using A.S. Byatt's and Harold Bloom's disparaging of the series to examine the significance of studying popular culture generally and medievalism in popular culture specifically. After providing a definition of medievalism and an overview of the medievalist tradition, I move into a close-reading of the series and Chaucer's dream visions, demonstrating the medievalism of the visions and memories. I then discuss nostalgia and discontent in both the medievalist tradition and contemporary Britain, showing that Voldemort's defeat successfully appeals to these cultural senses. I end my argument with a brief analysis of the films, arguing that, because the visions are faithfully adapted, the films belong to the genre of medieval film.

The role of medievalism in the plot and the resultant appeal to cultural nostalgia shows that Rowling is engaging with ideology in the texts. Rather than simply entertaining children, Rowling is both entertaining children and instructing adults. The questions of *Harry Potter's* appropriate readership has appeared in criticism of the series. The role of medievalism has implications for this debate, and I ultimately suggest that, in using medievalism to appeal to cultural nostalgia, Rowling has made her work literature for children and adults alike.

"DUMBING DOWN": CRITICAL SIGNIFICANCE OF STUDYING MEDIEVALISM

Shortly after *Order of the Phoenix* was published, A.S. Byatt wrote a *New York Times* Op-Ed about the series. She wonders why adults enjoy *Harry Potter*, but her answer is unsatisfactory. While her claim that "being taught literature often destroys the life of a book" may be true for some adults, it seems a stretch to insist that those adults then revert back to children's books. She claims, also, that "Ms. Rowling speaks to an adult generation that hasn't known, and doesn't care about, mystery." Charles Taylor, responding to Byatt in *Salon*, suggests her use of "mystery" refers to real-life mysteries:

And still Byatt trudges on, claiming that "Rowling speaks to an adult generation that hasn't known, and doesn't care about, mystery. They are inhabitants of urban jungles and not the real wild." Well, if the author biography in my Modern Library edition of Byatt's "Possession" is correct, the closest she has ever come to the "real wild" is growing up the daughter of a barrister and a schoolteacher in darkest Yorkshire. Unless those pages are missing an episode where, Jane-like, Byatt swung from the jungly tendrils, then it's fair to ask how a life spent in boarding school in the British city of York, then Cambridge, Bryn Mawr and Oxford before settling in London, gave her experience of the real wild.

While Taylor's scathing response certainly holds water, it seems likely that Byatt's use of the word "mystery" refers to mystery in literature. Her claim immediately follows two paragraphs discussing the children's authors of "the recent past," citing the "real sense of mystery, powerful forces, dangerous creatures in dark forests" found in works by Susan Cooper and Alan Garner. Contrasting Rowling with this type of description does not work, because *Harry Potter* contains all of these elements. Although the series is considered part of the fantasy genre, rather than the

mystery genre, each installment nonetheless has at least one mystery Harry and his friends must solve, always indicated in the title. To indicate that the series contains no powerful forces is to indicate that one has not read the series. In all but the third and sixth books, Harry battles Voldemort directly. Dumbledore is more powerful than Voldemort; and Harry himself embodies a pure form of love, a protection given to him when Lily sacrificed her life for him, which is part of the reason Voldemort cannot kill Harry. "Dangerous creatures in dark forests" are particularly important in *Chamber of Secrets*. Aragog explains that Hagrid never opened the Chamber, but he also permits his family to try to eat Harry and Ron (279). Considering these elements in the series makes Byatt's claims rather unsatisfactory.

Byatt further suggests that readers today "don't have the skills to tell ersatz magic from the real thing." One wonders what she means by "the real thing." Presumably she is referring to more realistic magic in books, but she gives no examples of which stories' magic might be considered more realistic. One might wonder, as well, how realistic Byatt expects a fantasy series to be. Throughout her article, she is concerned with the "real." The books she considers better than Rowling's have "real mystery," and "[t]he important thing about this particular secondary world is that it is symbiotic with the real modern world" (1). This claim about Rowling's world serves to undermine Byatt's argument about real and ersatz magic. If Rowling's Wizarding world is, indeed, "symbiotic with the real" Muggle world we inhabit, then it seems the magic in her series must be as realistic as other fantasy writers' magic. All literary magic, though, must be ersatz by virtue of existing only in a book. These many problems with Byatt's article create the impression that she does not have a well-formed rebuttal to Harry's popularity. Rather, she seems nostalgic for what she considered better children's literature.

Like Byatt's, Harold Bloom's aversion to *Harry Potter* seems rooted in personal nostalgia. Taylor criticized Byatt for her "snobbishness," but her elitism pales next to that of Bloom, or, as Taylor calls him, "that esteemed gasbag." Bloom's 2000 article pointedly ignores audience perception of *Harry Potter*, but he is keenly aware of how his audience is likely to perceive him. While the *Wall Street Journal* is not aimed at the same general readership as the *New York Times* or *Washington Post*, its audience is not a scholarly one. By those outside the academy, professors are often seen as infallible sources of wisdom, and Bloom knows that his being a professor establishes the authority he needs to write an article devoid of actual literary criticism—his opinion, he knows, will pass for such. Using this "authority," he strives to convince his readers that *Harry Potter and the Sorcerer's Stone* is a poorly-written novel, that many of Harry's fans "simply will not read superior fare," that Rowling relies on cliché, and that *Harry Potter* is helping the *New York Times* in its "dumbing down" of America.

The problems with Bloom's opinions are many. The biggest of these is his failure to take *Harry Potter and the Sorcerer's Stone* for what it is: the first installment of a fantasy series for children. He does not seem opposed to children's literature as such, calling *The Wind in the Willows*, *Alice in Wonderland*, and *Through the Looking Glass* "superior fare." Fantasy, it seems, is the problem. He does not blast Tolkien outright, but he does decry Rowling's refiguring of *Tom Brown's School Days* in "the magical mirror of Tolkien." One might also question his assertions about Rowling's prose. He cites "seven clichés, all of the 'stretch his legs' variety" on page four of *Sorcerer's Stone*. Three years later, Bloom wrote a scathing reaction to Stephen King's receipt of a National Book Foundation's award, which he considers part of the "phenomenon" that has children reading *Harry Potter*. He used the same example in attempting to prove that "Rowling's

mind is so governed by cliches and dead metaphors she has no other style of writing." That he cannot find another example of Rowling's cliché-governed mind indicates that this is the only instance and that Rowling does not, in fact, rely on clichés. Further, this claim is inaccurate. While page four of *Sorcerer's Stone* does contain the phrase "stretch his legs"—Mr. Dursley decides to do so on his lunch break—that is the only use of the phrase on this page. Unless Bloom is using an unusual definition of the word "cliche," there are no other cliches on that page, much less six others.

In the 2000 article, Bloom "hope[s] that [his] discontent is not merely a highbrow snobbery, or a nostalgia for a more literate fantasy," but, of course, it is both of these things. Like Byatt, he seems to believe the literature he read as a child was better than the literature today's children read. He seems nostalgic, too, for the academy as it used to be. In the 2003 article, he condemns study of writers he did not study:

I began as a scholar of the romantic poets. In the 1950s and early 1960s, it was understood that the great English romantic poets were Percy Bysshe Shelley, William Wordsworth, Lord Byron, John Keats, William Blake, Samuel Taylor Coleridge. But today they are Felician Hemans, Charlotte Smith, Mary Tighe, Laetitia Landon, and others who just can't write. A fourth-rate playwright like Aphra Behn is being taught instead of Shakespeare in many curriculums across the country.

This claim seems rather ridiculous, especially since Felicia Hemans and Letitia Landon more appropriately bear the label "Victorian" than "Romantic." His anger also seems misogynist, when his list of "good writers" is all male and his list of "bad writers" all female. Bloom's criticism is well established and infuriating to many. It is also useful.

In his introduction to *Against Academia*, Ray Browne condemns the preservation of the academy Bloom so desires. Brown, who founded the Popular Culture Association and is generally considered the father of popular culture studies, writes, "Instead of using knowledge as

a basis on which to build, especially in the Humanities, human beings are generally content to stir around laterally in the cold ashes of today and yesterday rather than to build new outpost fires down the line into tomorrow" (1). Popular culture studies form one such outpost fire, which Browne calls "a kind of class action suit against conventional points of view and fields of study in the Humanities" (1). Bloom would probably agree, though Browne uses that description with a tone of pride. The "class-action suit," he says, asks scholars to do what Bloom will not, that is, to think as carefully about the canon as they do about contemporary and popular texts (2). It also encourages acceptance of thinking about popular texts as critically as scholars think about the canon. To some English academics, pop culturalists are the Other scholars, to the point that PCA/ACA (Popular Culture Association/American Culture Association) members sometimes have to convince colleagues that papers on literature are welcome at the annual convention. Pop culture studies, as its scholars must reinforce, are not meant to undermine English, or to support the "dumbing-down" of American culture, as Bloom suggests.

Like Browne, Leslie J. Workman faced much resistance when he proposed medievalism as an area of study. In "The Founding and the Founder: Medievalism and the Legacy of Leslie J. Workman," his widow, Kathleen Verduin, discusses the difficulties he faced in gaining support from medievalists:

Medievalism as an innovative concept was hardly meeting the kind of open-armed approval Leslie may have expected. In June of 1978 he sent a long memo to the Medieval Institute at Western in a quixotic expectation of institutional support... The same document admits, however, that "The editor's conviction that it" — medievalism — "is a major phenomenon analogous in scope and potential interest to Romanticism is not shared by his colleagues," and indeed that "those who work in museums" were not seeing the light either: Leslie's applications for a Winterthur fellowship in 1978 and 1979 were both turned down... Although an approving TEAMS reviewer would observe in 1981 that "[t]eachers of medieval subjects will find *Studies in Medievalism* both a stimulus

for tying together literary trends and ideas as well as a forum for understanding medieval scholarship," the Medieval Institute remained apparently impervious to Leslie's exercised insistence (5 December 1978) that "Medievalism is a big subject, bigger than Romanticism, and at the moment we have it all. I have a very solid board of editors, most of them with at least one good book to their credit, all young and moving fast"; Miami [University of Ohio] declined further support on the grounds that *Studies in Medievalism* was not a strictly institutional enterprise (11).

The University of Akron published a few issues of *Studies in Medievalism*, but the journal then became, in Verduin's words, "a journal in search of a home" (12). Happily, the journal did find a home and is published now by D.S. Brewer. Workman, like Browne, was able to establish his discipline. It is thanks to Browne's effort that the PCA/ACA and its regional associations can have annual meetings and publish both popular and American culture journals. Workman's efforts resulted in the continuing publication of *Studies in Medievalism* and the presence of panels about medievalism at Kalamazoo. Scholars like Bloom reinforce the need for the study Browne and Workman encouraged.

CHAUCER, MACROBIUS, AND ROWLING: MEDIEVALISM IN *HARRY POTTER'S* VISIONS AND MEMORIES

Part of studying medievalism includes striving for a definition. The preface to *Studies in Medievalism* 8 supplied the definition "the continuing process of creating the Middle Ages" (Verduin 1), a definition with which I largely agree. The definition I find most useful, though, comes from Kathleen Verduin's reflection on "the broader range of implications on which he [Leslie J. Workman] insisted":

medievalism involved any engagement with the Middle Ages, conscious or unconscious, from the lunatic fringe of medievalist kitsch to the most solemn scholarship and from approximately 1500 to the present and beyond; and it broached consistently the question of why the "Middle Ages," the *medium aevum* bracketed off by sixteenth-century humanists, had to be invented at all (24).

Because of the phrase "conscious or unconscious," this is the definition I mean when I discuss medievalism in this thesis. Rowling clearly intended the series to have obvious medieval references: much of Hogwarts's history is based in the Middle Ages, many of the ghosts died in the Middle Ages, "Merlin's pants!" or "Merlin's beard!" serve as oaths approximately as strong as "damn!," and Sir Cadogan provides much-needed comic relief in the otherwise grim *Prisoner of Azkaban*. However, her connection to medieval literature seems mostly unconscious⁴. The connection to medieval literature is the subject of this chapter, seen through analysis of Chaucer's dream visions, compared with an analysis of Harry's visions and others' memories. In analyzing

⁴ The exception is the *Tale of the Three Brothers*, for which the *Pardoner's Tale* is the source.

visions, I use J. Stephen Russell's terms for the parts of the vision: the prologue, which establishes the dreamer's distressed or anxious state and describes the events leading to the dream; the dream report, which is the narration of the dream itself; and the epilogue, in which the dreamer awakes and reflects on the dream.

Harry's visions are the two distinct ways in which the connection between Harry's and Voldemort's minds manifests itself: actual dreams, which Harry experiences while sleeping; and semi-conscious daydreams, which are usually heralded by Harry's scar aching and during which Harry clearly sees where Voldemort is and what he is doing, from Voldemort's point of view. Only three of Harry's actual dreams are part of this analysis. The first occurs in chapter twenty-one, "The Eye of the Snake," of *Order of the Phoenix*. It begins as an ordinary dream, full of random visions from Harry's waking concerns, and then switches so that Harry experiences Nagini's attack on Arthur Weasley. The second actual dream occurs later in *Order the Phoenix*, in chapter thirty-one, "O.W.L.s." Harry has this dream after falling asleep during his History of Magic O.W.L. This is an "actual dream" because Harry is asleep when it happens, but the vision itself is false. Harry dreams of Voldemort torturing Sirius, which is not actually happening; Voldemort plants a false dream to lure Harry to the Department of Mysteries. The last actual dream I examine comes at the beginning of *Deathly Hallows'* seventh chapter, "The Will of Albus Dumbledore" and is the shortest, with only a paragraph of narration. This dream shows Voldemort searching abroad for Gregorovitch, as Harry explains upon waking.

The rest of Harry's visions in *Deathly Hallows* are semi-conscious. He has too many of these visions for them all to be listed here, but for clarity, I provide an example. The night that Harry and his six doppelgängers travel to the Burrow, Hedwig and Moody are killed. Harry

walks outside, trying to clear his mind, and the vision comes to him "out of nowhere." He sees Voldemort torturing Olivander for information. The narration makes clear that Harry has not fallen asleep, saying that "out of nowhere, the pain in his scar peaked. As he clutched his forehead and closed his eyes, a voice screamed inside his head" (84). The vision "was over as quickly as it had come: Harry stood shaking in the darkness, clutching the gate into the garden, his heart racing, his scar still tingling" (85). There are no words such as "awoke," to indicate that Harry dreamed of Voldemort and Olivander. He has remained awake but aware only of the events in the vision, not of anything happening at the Burrow in that moment. Harry has visions like this throughout the book, each providing new information that contributes to his eventual defeat of Voldemort. Although they are different types of visions, the actual dreams and the semi-conscious daydreams are of equal importance to the narrative and, therefore, to my argument. As I will argue more fully, the visions are one of the most important elements of Harry's ability to defeat Voldemort. This defeat, in turn, allows the series to fully appeal to readers' nostalgia, which is the subject of the next chapter.

Two sets of memories are important for this analysis: those Harry and Dumbledore view in *Half-Blood Prince* and those Snape gives Harry just before dying. One of the major plot points of *Half-Blood Prince* is Harry and Dumbledore's examination of memories about Voldemort. Through examining these memories, Dumbledore is able to confirm that Voldemort created Horcruxes. The memories also equip Harry with information he needs to identify the Horcruxes and recognize Voldemort's weaknesses. Harry is further helped by the memories Snape leaves him. They give him a new understanding of Snape's personality, and, more importantly, they show him that he must sacrifice himself.

Harry's visions and others' memories are key to Harry's defeat of Voldemort. These features of the text are medievalisms because of several strong parallels to Chaucer's three major dream visions: the *Book of the Duchess*, the *Parliament of Fowls*, and the *House of Fame*. In *Harry Potter*, the visions and memories have the same relationship with temporality that Chaucer's dream visions have. The memories are further medievalisms because Chaucer's dream visions are all memories. There is an element of personal nostalgia in one of those visions, the *Book of the Duchess*, as there is in Slughorn's and Snape's memories. The visions are further medievalisms because, as are Chaucer's narrators, Harry is distressed before dreaming or experiencing a vision, and because the dreams can be read in Macrobian terms.

Using visions to tell part of the narrative links Rowling to Chaucer, who often used the form. Three of Chaucer's major poems are dream visions; his longest works, the *Canterbury Tales* and *Troilus and Criseyde*, though not themselves dream visions, both contain short versions of the form. In the dream vision poems, Chaucer's narrator discusses interest in the form. The *House of Fame* opens with a reflection on the categories of dreams:

God turne us every drem to goode!
For hyt is wonder, be the roode,
To my wyt, what causeth swevenes
Eyther on morwes or on evenes,
And why th'effect folweth of somme,
And of somme hit shal never come;
Why that is an avision
And why this a revelacion,
Why this a drem, why that a sweven,
And noght to every man lyche even;
Why this a fantome, why these oracles (1-11).

Chaucer's narrator in the *Book of the Duchess* also wonders about types of dreams, saying, "Such fantasies ben in myn hede/ so I know not what to do" (28-29). The *House of Fame* narrator goes on to discuss major figures in the history of dream interpretation:

For now at erste shal ye here
So sely an avisyon,
That Isaye, ne Scipion,
Ne kyng Nabugodonosor,
Pharoo, Turnus, ne Elcanor,
Ne mette such a drem as this (512-517).

These lines show that Chaucer, like Macrobius before him, wondered about the types and causes of dreams. He also differs from Macrobius. In the *Commentary*, Macrobius expresses interest in causes and types but then explains the five types of dreams and what causes them. Chaucer's narrator, on the other hand, simply wonders about these features of dreams. Also unlike Macrobius, Chaucer prays that all his dreams will lead to goodness; Macrobius only explains dreams⁵. Chaucer's narrator in the *Book of the Duchess* is also uncertain about dreams, in contrast to Macrobius' certainty. That narrator complains that "such fantasies ben in myn hede/ So I not what is best to do" (28-29). Rather than interpreting his dreams or reading Macrobius' *Commentary* to take instruction from his dreams, this narrator merely expresses confusion. This departure from the certainty about dreams that Macrobius displays begins to show Chaucer's willingness to experiment with the form, a willingness I discuss further at a later point in this chapter. Thus, not only do Harry's visions parallel Chaucer's dream visions as a form, but they also engage with a literary concern that has been considered by authors since the Middle Ages.

When analyzing temporality in this series, I refer to the role of the past, present, and future, independently and as interconnected forces over the vision. The role of the past is that

⁵ As I show in the next chapter, Rowling fulfills Chaucer's first line, turning all of Harry's visions into his victory.

each of Chaucer's narrator's visions is possible because of some past event or artifact, usually a work of literature. Harry's visions, too, are possible because of past events: Trelawney's prophecy and Voldemort's resultant attack on the Potters. All of these visions⁶ have direct and indirect impacts on the future.

In the *Book of the Duchess* and the *Parliament*, the narrator references past events and names Classical texts, and we can see that, in this way, the past allows the dreams to occur. In the *Book of the Duchess*, the dreamer tells us that he has "suffred this eight yeer" from insomnia. This indicates that some past event, though the dreamer does not say what, has caused his insomnia. Because he cannot sleep, the narrator decides to read from Ovid's *Metamorphoses* (47-8). After reading the story of Seys and Alcyone, the narrator prays for Morpheus or Juno to help him sleep (242-6). Immediately, "[s]uch a lust anoon me took/ To slepe that ryght upon my book/ Y fil aslepe" (273-5). Therefore, the role of the past in the narrator's ability to dream is clear: a past event has caused his sleeplessness, and a book written in the the past enables him to sleep.

The *Parliament* follows this same form. Like the narrator in the *Book of the Duchess*, the *Parliament's* narrator does not explain the original cause of his distress. He also does not tell us how long he has suffered the pangs of frustrated love, but the prologue indicates that he has been distressed for some time. The phrase "the craft so long to lerne" in the opening line suggests that he has struggled for some lengthy amount of time to learn about the art of love. Later in the prologue, he refers to "al this new science that men lere" (25). He does not say what this science is, but the phrasing indicates that the narrator is old enough to recall the old science, whatever it

⁶ With the exception of Chaucer's unfinished *House of Fame*.

may have been. If the "new science" were familiar to him because he was the same age as the men who study it, it seems more likely that he would have called it by its name. Like the *Book of the Duchess'* narrator, this narrator has suffered emotional turmoil for some lengthy amount of time. To ease this distress, he, like the other narrator, chooses to read a Classical text. This narrator chooses to read Cicero's *Dream of Scipio*, and it is this specific text that makes the connection between Harry's visions and Chaucer's particularly strong. According to Macrobius, Scipio's dream is prophetic (90). Thus the *Parliament's* dream is possible because of a prophetic event in the past.

This same type of even is partly responsible for Harry's visions. They are all possible because of Voldemort's attack on one-year-old Harry, as Dumbledore explains in *Deathly Hallows*:

"on the night Lord Voldemort tried to kill him...a fragment of Voldemort's soul was blasted apart from the whole, and latched itself onto the only living soul left in that collapsed building. Part of Lord Voldemort lives inside Harry, and it is that which gives him the power of speech with snakes, and a connection with Lord Voldemort's mind that he has never understood" (686).

Voldemort's attack is the direct cause of Harry's visions, but Trelawney's prophecy is indirectly responsible. As Dumbledore explains to Harry, Voldemort attempted to murder one-year-old Harry because of the prophecy (*OotP* 839). The attack happened fourteen years prior to Harry's first vision, the prophecy fifteen and a half years before⁷. That the causes of these visions were in the past connects Rowling's use of the past to Chaucer's; that both authors used a prophetic event strengthens this connection.

⁷ The first vision occurs in December of 1995. Voldemort attacked the Potters on Hallowe'en 1981 (*DH* 328), and the prophecy was made "shortly before [Harry's] birth" (*OotP* 839), which was on 31 July 1980.

Visions and memories all occur in a simultaneous but different present. The *Book of the Duchess* and the *Parliament* both make clear that the dreamer is in his room but also in the Classical location of his dream. In the *Book of the Duchess*, he falls asleep on his book (273-4), so he clearly has not left his study. Yet he is physically present in the dream:

I was go walked fro my tree,
And as I wente, ther cam by mee
A whelp, that fauned me as I stood...
And I hym folwed, and hyt forth wente (387-9, 397)

The phrases "I...walked," "I wente," and "I...folwed" make it clear that the dreamer is not sitting elsewhere, watching the events of the dream. He is present, actively participating. When he wakes, though, he wakes in his room:

Therwyth I awook myselve
And fond me lyinge in my bed;
And the book that I hadde red,
Of Alcione and Says the kyng,
And of the goddes of slepyng,
I fond hyt in myn hond ful even (1324-9).

He never left his bed or even dropped the book upon which he fell asleep. Since he was also a participant in the hunt and conversation of the dream, he has been, in effect, in two places at once.

The *Parliament's* narrator experiences the same phenomenon. He changes into night-clothes and gets into bed:

But fynally my spirit at the laste,
For wery of my labour al the day,
Tok reste, that made me to slepe faste;
And in my slep I mette, as that I lay,
How Affrican, ryght in the selve aray
That Scipion hym say byfore that tyde,
Was come and stod right at my beddes syde (92-8).

This dream begins with the narrator clearly still in his bedroom. In the dream, he leaves his room and finds himself in front of a gate, wondering whether to go through. He asks Scipio what to do, and

With that myn hand in his he tok anon,
Of which I confort caughte, and wente in faste.
But, Lord, so I was glad and wel begoon!
For overal where that I myne eyes caste
Were treës clad with leves that ay shal laste (169-73).

As in the *Book of the Duchess*, Chaucer uses action verbs to show that the dreamer is physically present in a place other than his room: he "wente in" to the garden through the gate and "caste" his eyes around the garden. Though he is mostly looking around, the phrase "wente in" shows that he did take the physical action of walking into the garden. This poem's dream report is mostly an account of the birds' attempts to find mates, which the dreamer observes and narrates, but in which he does not participate. However, the narration before their parliament makes clear that the narrator is present in the garden. When he awakes, he immediately picks up a book: "I wok, and othere bokes tok me to" (695). There is no indication that anything happens between his waking and beginning to read again. To immediately take up a book, he must still be in his room. Thus, like the narrator in the *Book of the Duchess*, this narrator is effectively in two places at once.

Harry, too, is physically present wherever he was in the moments just before the vision and wherever the vision is occurring. For example, when he dreams of Voldemort attacking Sirius, it is clear that he has not left his exam desk in the great hall:

Think, he told himself, his face in his hands, while all around him quills scratched out never-ending answers and the sand trickled through the hourglass at the front...

He was walking along the cool, dark corridor to the Department of Mysteries again, walking with a firm and purposeful tread, breaking occasionally into a run, determined to reach his destination at last...The black door swung open for him as usual, and here he was in the circular room with its many doors... (*OotP* 726-7).

There is no shift in tone between the final paragraph narrating Harry's frustrated attempts to complete his History of Magic O.W.L. and the first paragraph narrating his dream. There is only an ellipsis, but this does not indicate any sort of definite change. Each paragraph about Harry's struggle during the exam ends in either an ellipsis or an em-dash as Harry's mind slips from thought to thought. Using the same punctuation in narrating the change from thinking about the exam to dreaming about the Ministry shows that Harry has not, in fact gone anywhere; he has again moved from one thought to another, but this new thought is a dream.

The narration upon Harry's waking also shows that he has not gone anywhere:

But somebody screamed as Voldemort lowered his wand again; somebody yelled and fell sideways off a hot desk onto the cold stone floor. Harry hit the ground and awoke, still yelling, his scar on fire, as the Great Hall erupted all around him...He was gibbering, trying to pull away from Professor Tofty, who was looking at him with much concern, and who had just helped Harry out into the entrance hall while the students all around them stared.

"I'm — I'm fine, sir," Harry stammered, wiping the sweat from his face. "Really...I just fell asleep...Had a nightmare..."

"Pressure of examinations!" said the old wizard sympathetically (728-9).

Professor Tofty is concerned that Harry has fallen asleep, but he is not surprised to see that he is present in the hall. If Harry had left and gone to the Department of Mysteries, someone would have noticed or commented. He was clearly still in his seat while dreaming. Yet it is also clear that Harry is in the Hall of Prophecy during the dream:

Harry saw a long-fingered white hand clutching a wand rise on the end of his own arm...heard the high, cold voice say, "*Crucio!*"

The man on the floor let out a scream of pain, attempted to stand but fell back, writhing. Harry was laughing. He raised his wand, the curse lifted, and the figure groaned and became motionless (727).

The opening paragraph of the vision, cited above, shows, as these paragraphs do, that Harry is physically present in the Department of Mysteries during the dream. The opening paragraph clearly says that "[h]e was walking," not seeing a vision of someone else walking through the Ministry. This is further indicated by these other two paragraphs. That the wand hand is "on the end of his own arm" shows that Harry is the one holding the wand, as later shown in the phrase "[h]e raised his wand." The personal pronouns *he* and *his* make it clear that, for the duration of the vision, Harry is Voldemort and therefore actually in the Hall of Prophecy, not just watching Voldemort torturing Sirius. Yet, as discussed above, Harry is also still present in the Great Hall.

There is a similar phenomenon in viewing memories in a Pensieve. When Harry views a memory, he does fall into the Pensieve: "Dumbledore's office gave an almighty lurch — Harry was thrown forward and pitched headfirst into the substance inside the basin." He is no longer standing on the office floor; when he is thrown into the basin, he "fall[s] through something icy-cold and black; it was like being sucked into a dark whirlpool" (*GoF* 585). Although his feet have left the office floor, though, Harry is still in the office, because he is in the Pensieve. This is indicated by the fact that Dumbledore finds him and pulls him out of the Pensieve (596). To know that Harry was in the Pensieve, viewing memories, Dumbledore must have been able to see Harry. We know that one can see the contents of the memory by simply looking into the Pensieve:

Harry bent closer, his head right inside the cabinet. The silvery substance had become transparent; it looked like glass. He looked down into it, expecting to see the stone bottom of the basin — and saw instead an enormous room below the surface of the mysterious substance, a room into which he seemed to be looking through a circular window in the ceiling... The basin being circular, and the room he was observing square, Harry could not make out what was going on in the corners of it. He leaned even closer, tilting his head, trying to see...

One must fall into the Pensieve to actually experience the memory but not to only see it.

Although there is no clear narration to tell how Dumbledore knew Harry was in the Pensieve, it seems likely that he would be able to simply look into the basin and see that Harry was inside, experiencing the memory. Yet Harry is also physically present in the memory:

And suddenly, Harry found himself sitting on a bench at the end of the room inside the basin, a bench raised high above the others...Not one of the witches and the wizards in the room (and there were at least two hundred of them) was looking at him. Not one of them seemed to have noticed that a fourteen-year-old boy had just dropped from the ceiling into their midst. Harry turned to the wizard next to him on the bench and uttered a loud cry of surprise that reverberated around the silent room (585).

The memory is of trials in the Ministry of Magic. Harry is obviously present in the memory, sitting among the Wizengamot, though he is also still in the office, inside of the Pensieve. As when he dreams or experiences a vision, Harry is, in effect, in two places at once. This connection is the strongest support for the argument that the memories are also visions. In addition to occurring in simultaneous versions of the present, the memories have the same impact on the future as the other visions: they are key to Harry's defeat of Voldemort.

Chaucer's narrators' and Harry's visions all have an impact on the future. In the *Book of the Duchess* and the *Parliament*, this significance is fairly simple. The end result of both dreams is that they both have a lasting impact on the dreamer. Chaucer's narrator in the *Parliament* "wok, and other bokes tok me to,/ To reede upon, and yit I rede alwey,/ I hope, ywis, to rede so som day" (695-7). The narrator, it seems, finds the inconclusive ending of the birds' parliament frustrating and must therefore immediately pick up a book. He has made clear during the prologue that he reads to soothe his frustration about love, so his need to continue reading indicates his continued frustration. The word "alwey" implies that he anticipates spending the

rest of his life reading in search of solace. That he says "som day" indicates that he does hope to find solace but is not overly optimistic. He does not say "soon" or in any way indicate that he thinks he will read "som thyng for to fare/ The bet" (697-8) in the near future. The speculative nature of the phrase "som day" indicates a sense that the dreamer's life will be effected by the dream's failure to bring him comfort. In the *Book of the Duchess*, the poem itself is the result of the dream. The narrator explains that, upon waking, he thought,

"Thys ys so queynt a sweven
That I wol, be process of tyme,
Fonde to put this sweven in ryme
As I can best, and that anoon" (1330-4).

Harry's visions have a much greater impact on the future. His dream about Arthur enables him to notify the Order of the attack, saving Arthur's life. It also alerts Dumbledore to the connection between Harry's and Voldemort's minds, which results in Harry taking Occlumency lessons from Snape. During this process, Voldemort becomes aware of the connection between their minds, and this allows him to plant the false dream about Sirius. This dream, though heartbreaking, is also crucial to Harry's eventual defeat of Voldemort. If he had not had this dream, he and other members of Dumbledore's Army would never have gone to the Ministry. The Order would not have come to their rescue, and Bellatrix would not have had the chance to kill Sirius. But Harry also would not have learned about the prophecy, and knowing that he is the Chosen One gives him the strength he needs to continue fighting Voldemort. The visions in *Deathly Hallows* have a much more practical application. These visions tell Harry where Voldemort is and what he is doing. While he, Ron, and Hermione are searching for the Horcruxes, this is merely useful. Once they steal Hufflepuff's cup, however, they become vital. At that point, Voldemort realizes Harry is destroying Horcruxes and begins going to all of his

hiding places to check on the Horcruxes. Once they arrive at Hogwarts, Harry uses the visions to notify McGonagall of Voldemort's approach, so that she can get as many students as possible to safety. They also directly lead to Harry's defeat of Voldemort, as do the memories, which I will explain more fully in the next chapter.

The relationship to temporality is part of my argument that the memories are medievalisms. This argument is furthered by the fact that each of Chaucer's dream reports is itself a memory. In each dream vision, it is evident that the narrator is remembering his dream: "thys was my sweven" (*BoD* 290); "as I slepte, me mette I was/ Withyn a temple ymad of glas" (*HoF* 119-120); "in my slep I mette" (*PoF* 95). All three dreams begin in the present: "I have gret wonder, be this lyght/ How that I lyve, for day ne night" (*BoD* 1-2); "God turne us every drem to goode!/ For hyt is wonder, be the roode,/ To my wyt, what causeth swevenes" (*HoF* 1-3);

Al this mene I by Love, that my felynge
Astonyeth with his wonderful werkyng
So sore, iwis, that what I on hym thynke
Nat wot I wel where that I flete or synke (*PoF* 4-7).

The narrators begin with present-tense narration but switch to past tense just before the dream report. This shift change makes it clear that each narrator is reporting a dream as he remembers it, not providing stream-of-consciousness narration as the dream occurs. The epilogues, too, report remembered events: "Therewyth I awook myselve/ And fond me lyinge in my bed" (*BoD* 1324-5); "I woke, and othere books tok me to" (*PoF* 695). After these past-tense descriptions of awaking, the narration returns to present-tense: "This was my sweven, now hit ys don" (*BoD* 1335); "I hope, ywis, to rede so som day/ That I shal mete som thyng for to fare/ The bet, and thus to rede I nyl nat spare" (697-700). By framing the dreams, written in past tense, in poems

that begin and end in the present tense (and, in *PoF*, with a nod to the future); Chaucer makes it clear that the experience of falling asleep, the events of the dreams, and the experience of waking up all happened in the past and are therefore memories.

In the prologue to the *Book of the Duchess*, there is a strong sense of personal nostalgia. The initial tone is distressed and reflective, describing the narrator's eight-year struggle with insomnia. Nostalgia is implied in lines 39-40, when the narrator says that "there is phisicien but oon/ That may me hele, but that is don." Wilcockson explains in his endnote that the identity of this physician is unknown (967). It is the phrase "but that is don" that indicates nostalgia. The exact use of *don* in this case is unclear. However, as the prologue is clearly reflective, and as the phrase comes right after "this eight yeer," it seems likely that *don* most closely matches our modern use of the word "done." If we read lines 39-40 to mean, roughly, "For there is but one physician who may heal me, but that is done," there is a clear sense of longing for a past time in which there was a physician who could have healed the narrator, but who is now unable to do so.

Personal nostalgia is also important for memories in *Harry Potter*. It is his memories, likely wistful, that drive Snape forward and encourage him to continue protecting and helping Harry. In *Deathly Hallows*, Snape's memories play the biggest role. He gets the sword of Gryffindor to Harry by sending his Patronus, a doe, to Harry in the Forest of Dean. The Patronus is a doe because Lily's was a doe, and Snape has never stopped loving Lily, as Harry learns in viewing the memories. The implication is that Snape's only happy memories are those of Lily. In the first memory after Lily's death, Snape is beside himself with grief:

The hilltop faded, and Harry stood in Dumbledore's office, and something was making a terrible sound, like a wounded animal. Snape was slumped forward in a chair and Dumbledore was standing over him, looking grim. After a moment or

two, Snape raised his face, and he looked like a man who had lived a hundred years of misery..."I wish...I wish *I* were dead..." (678).

This is a definite change from Snape's attitude in his earlier memories. In those, he sometimes seems desperate, but he is desperate for Lily's love. Now, he is distraught because of Lily's death. He feels that he has nothing to live for. In a later memory, Harry sees Dumbledore ask whether Snape has grown to care for Harry, and Snape casts his Patronus. Dumbledore turns and asks, "After all this time?" Snape replies, "Always" (687). To cast a Patronus, one must focus on a happy memory. To send the stag that leads Harry to the sword, Snape must have been thinking of some time he spent with Lily. All this indicates that Snape is nostalgic for the time he spent with Lily.

Personal nostalgia plays an even greater role in Harry's retrieval of Slughorn's memory. To do this, Harry must appeal to Slughorn's sense of personal nostalgia, which is extraordinarily wistful and pessimistic. Harry describes the scene of his parents' death, which he has learned from Voldemort himself and from his own suppressed memories, which the dementors force him to relive. Harry tells Slughorn, "He told me she needn't have died. He only wanted me. She could have run." Slughorn repeats, "She could have...she needn't..." As Harry continues, Slughorn remembers Lily: "I don't imagine anyone who met her wouldn't have liked her...Very brave...Very funny...It was the most horrible thing..." The combined effect of Harry's memory of the night his parents died and Slughorn's memories of Lily finally get Slughorn to hand over the memory. He tells Slughorn, "But you won't help her son...She gave me her life, but you won't give me a memory." Pessimistically, Slughorn protests, "It isn't a question...If it were to help you, of course...but no purpose can be served..." Harry persists, appealing to Slughorn's nostalgia, "Be brave like my mother, professor," at which Slughorn finally provides Harry with

the memory. Once he recognizes Slughorn's nostalgia for the time when Lily was his student, Harry knows to change his tactic and appeal to this nostalgia, finally breaking Slughorn down and receiving the memory. In the *Book of the Duchess*, nostalgia leads to a dream that is narrated as a memory. In *Half-Blood Prince* and *Deathly Hallows*, nostalgia leads to memories Harry needs to defeat Voldemort.

Having argued that the memories are medievalisms, I turn now to making this argument about the visions. Before experiencing a vision, the dreamer is always emotionally distressed, as J. Stephen Russell notes (6). The narrator in the *Book of Duchess*, it seems, is distressed because he cannot sleep, saying:

I have gret wonder, be this lyght,
How that I lyve, for day ne nyght
I may nat slepe wel nygh noght;
I have so many an ydel thought
Purley for defaute of slep
That, by my trouthe, I tak no kep
Of nothing, how hyt cometh or gooth,
Ne me nys nothing leef nor looth (1-8).

The first two lines suggest that the dreamer has suffered from insomnia for so long that he does not know how it is physically possible for him to be alive. His idle thoughts, he says, are due to his lack of sleep; if he could sleep, it seems, he would not be listless. Since he cannot, though, he is unable to stay aware of what is happening around him. Because his sleeplessness is directly connected to his discontent, the dream will be particularly important, not only giving him something to consider upon waking, but also indicating that he has fallen asleep and therefore found some amount of ease.

Chaucer's narrator in the *Parliament* does not have trouble sleeping. Instead, he is distressed by his ineptitude as a lover. The poem begins:

The lyf so short, the craft so longe to lerne,
Th'assay so hard, so sharp the conquerynge,
The dredful joye alwey that slit so yerne,
Al this mene I by Love, that my felynge
Astonyeth with his wonderful werkyng
So sore, iwys, that whan I on him thynke
Nat wot I wel wher that I flete or synke (1-6).

His inability to fall in love has him desperate. The first line indicates a fear that he will not learn "the craft" of love before his life is over. Like the narrator in the *Book of the Duchess*, this narrator feels somewhat out of control. The *Duchess* narrator does not know what is happening around him. This narrator, in saying, "Nat wot I wel wher that I flete or synke," indicates that, when he thinks about love, he cannot tell whether or not he is in control or fully aware of the situation around him. If he floats, then he is; if he sinks, then he is not. He does not know which is the case. His dream will not indicate ease, but it will teach him something about love.

Like Chaucer's narrators, Harry experiences emotional turmoil before dreaming. His first dream vision occurs halfway through *Order of the Phoenix*, just before the Christmas break. After the last D.A. meeting of the term, Harry and Cho Chang share a kiss under the mistletoe. During the kiss, Cho begins to cry. When Harry tells Ron and Hermione, the latter explains that Cho is feeling confused, happy, sad, guilty, and worried, simultaneously. Even more confused, Harry lies awake, thinking, "That's what they should teach us here...how girls' brains work" (462). When he does fall asleep, he first dreams confusedly of Cho and then of Nagini attacking Mr. Weasley. It seems that his distress caused the dream. Before dreaming that Voldemort is torturing Sirius, Harry is struggling to complete his History of Magic O.W.L. exam: "Think, he told himself, his face in his hands, while all around him quills scratched out never-ending answers and the sand trickled through the hourglass at the front" (*OotP* 726). Here his

distress is physically manifested, forcing Harry to rest his head in his hands. Before the last actual dream at the Burrow, Harry and Mrs. Weasley discuss plans for his seventeenth birthday dinner. She tells him, "Not at all, not at all...It's no trouble," but Harry still "felt a great wave of remorse for the inconvenience and the pain he was giving her" (*DH* 110). Although his distresses are not the same as Chaucer's narrators', the presence of narration that works as a prologue and establishes Harry's distress before the dreams is an important connection to Chaucer's visions. Though the dreamers are very different, the basic form of their dreams is the same.

As before the dreams, Harry is distressed before he experiences a semi-conscious vision. For example, Harry's scar becomes increasingly painful as he, Ron, and Hermione plan to sneak into the Ministry. He rushes from the kitchen at Grimmauld Place to the bathroom and experiences a vision of Voldemort killing a family as he searches for Gregorovitch:

"I want Gregorovitch."

"*Er wohnt hier nicht mehr!*" she cried, shaking her head. "He no live here! He no live here! I know him not!"...He raised the wand. She screamed. Two young children came running into the hall. She tried to shield them with her arms. There was a flash of green light — (*DH* 232-3).

Although that evening is less distressing than some of the others in *Deathly Hallows* — Harry speaks "calmly" (230) and jokes (231) — Harry is not at ease. He pretends certainty that they are ready to go into the Ministry, but "he was not particularly confident" (231). He is fully aware that he, Ron, and Hermione all face arrest if they are caught. He is similarly distressed before his other visions. As with the dreams, this distress connects these visions to Chaucer's visions dream visions.

Harry's visions can be read in Macrobian terms, and this is the second way in which they are medievalisms. In Macrobius' view, there are five categories of dream:

the enigmatic dream, in Greek *oneiros*, in Latin *somnium*; second, there is the prophetic vision, in Greek *horama*, in Latin *visio*; third, there is the oracular dream, in Greek *chrematismos*, in Latin *oraculum*; fourth, there is the nightmare, in Greek *enypnion*, in Latin *insomnium*; and last, the apparition, in Greek *phantasma*, which Cicero, when he has occasion to use the word, calls *visum* (88).

Macrobius' *Commentary* was read throughout the Middle Ages, as was Cicero's *Dream of Scipio* itself. Each of Chaucer's dream visions makes mention of these texts:

Ne nat skarsly Macrobeus
(He that wrot al th'avysyoun
That he mette, kyng Scipioun,
The noble man, the Affrikan—
Such marvayles fortuneth than) (*Book of the Duchess* 284-288);

So Sely an avisyon,
That Isaye, ne Scipion,
Ne kyng Nabugodonosor,
Pharoo, Turnus, ne Elcanor,
Ne mette such a drem as this (*House of Fame* 513-517);

This bok of which I make mencion
Entitled was al then, as I shal telle:
"Tullyus of the Drem of Scipioun" (*Parliament of Fowls* 29-31).

Because medieval dream visions can be read in Macrobian terms and were influenced by the *Commentary*, reading Harry's visions in these terms further demonstrates their medievalism.

Of course, the dream vision has evolved, and Chaucer's dream visions do not fit perfectly into Macrobius' categories. The *Parliament* is a perfect example. The prologue clearly establishes the narrator's state as a distressed lover, and the dream shows him birds' frustrated attempts to find a mate. The dream appears to be influenced by his waking concerns, which makes it seem like a nightmare. However, Macrobius' description of the nightmare clearly indicates that the events in a nightmare must happen to the dreamer personally, explaining that

the patient experiences in dreams vexations similar to those that disturb him during the day...we might mention the lover who dreams of possessing his sweetheart or of losing her, or the man who fears the plots or might of an enemy and is confronted with him in his dream or seems to be fleeing him (88).

This language clearly indicates that the dreamer is not watching someone else experience troubling events; he is the main character in the dream. Chaucer's narrator only watches in the *Parliament*. None of the events in the dream actually happen to him, but the inconclusive ending of the dream does seem to foreshadow the inconclusive ending of the poem. In this sense, the dream comes true. The actual events are fictional, but the frustrated suitors in the dream translate to the dreamer's still-frustrated state upon waking. This prophetic nature of the dream, combined with the fact that the dreamer is not an actual participant in the dream, makes it more like the alien variety of an enigmatic dream. The enigmatic dream is one of the prophetic dreams Macrobius describes. This type of dream "conceals with strange shapes and veils with ambiguity the true meaning of the information being offered" (90). The *Parliament* dream does this through the allegory of the birds, representing the dreamer's frustration and foretelling its continuation. The enigmatic is the only type of dream in which Macrobius suggests that other people might be the objects of the dream's actions, explaining that an enigmatic dream is "alien, when he dreams this about someone else" (90). In the case of the *Parliament*, Chaucer's narrator dreams about birds, not about himself, making the dream an alien enigmatic one. From this analysis, we can see that Chaucer, though he read Macrobius, took liberties with the dream vision from, fitting his into more than one category of dreams.

Harry's visions, too, mostly fit more than one of Macrobius' categories. His semi-conscious visions are partly apparitions and partly prophetic dreams. Because Harry is not asleep but does not seem to be fully awake when he has these dreams, they seem to be apparitions.

These are the only dreams Macrobius describes that occur while neither fully asleep nor fully awake. The actual events of Harry's visions, however, do not line up with the events in an apparition, during which the dreamer "sees specters rushing at him or wandering vaguely about, differing from natural creatures in shape or size" (89). There is one parallel between these dreams, as Macrobius describes them, and Harry's visions. In the visions, Harry is Voldemort and so often speaks in Voldemort's unnaturally high-pitched and unfeeling voice or sees his long and white fingers, serpentine nose, or red eyes. Because he is Voldemort, he does not see anyone rushing at him. However, Voldemort looks like a cross between a man and a snake, bringing an element of the unnatural to the dreams, a feature apparitions must have in Macrobian terms. In other aspects, the visions are more closely prophetic, visions which, in Macrobius' terms, show events that come true. Because all of Harry's semi-conscious visions show events as they happen, they clearly meet this criteria. We can see, therefore, that Harry's semi-conscious visions meet Macrobius' terms for both the apparition and the prophetic vision.

Harry's recurring dreams about the Department of Mysteries in *Order of the Phoenix* are prophetic. As he does in the dreams, he ends up going to the Department of Mysteries, has trouble entering, and, finally, gains access. Harry begins having dreams about the Department of Mysteries in the summer, but they always end at a locked door he cannot open. It is not until after Christmas that the door finally opens, leading him through the outer rooms into the Hall of Prophecy (635). Several weeks later, he dreams of going to row ninety-seven in the Hall (682). It is not clear whether Harry is seeing Voldemort himself successfully making these trips into the Department of Mysteries. It is certain, though, that they foretell Harry's eventual trip to the Hall of Prophecy.

Harry's months of failure to gain entry play out in real life in his difficulty getting through the initial room. As soon as Ginny closes the door through which they entered, the wall of doors begins to rotate, so that Harry doesn't know which door is the one from his dreams. As they try several doors and grow frustrated, Hermione reminds them of the prophetic nature of Harry's dreams:

"Right, we're leaving that room," said Hermione decisively.

"But what if that's the one?" said Ron, staring at it with a mixture of apprehension and longing.

"It can't be, Harry could get through all the doors in his dream," said Hermione, marking the door with another fiery cross as Harry replaced the now-useless handle of Sirius' knife in his pocket (776).

Although Hermione suggested that Harry's dream about Voldemort torturing Sirius may have truly been a dream with no significance, she does seem convinced that Harry's other dreams about the Department of Mysteries were, indeed, prophetic. If Harry could gain entry in his dreams, he can gain entry in real life. She is proven right with the next door, which easily opens to the room Harry immediately recognizes from his dreams "by the beautiful, dancing, diamond-sparkling light" (776). Reassured now, he leads the others through the room, "heading, as he had done in his dream, for the source of the light," which leads them all into the Hall of Prophecy, as it always had in the dreams (777). Because they foretell the future, these dreams are clearly prophetic in Macrobian terms. They fit into this category, also, because they are not influenced by any waking concerns.

If Harry's dreams of the Department of Mysteries were influenced by his worries while awake, they might more accurately fit somewhere between the nightmare and the prophetic dream. However, there are no daytime concerns that serve as the impetus for these dreams. They are, in fact, initially contrasted to nightmares caused by Harry's worries:

In the meantime, he had nothing to look forward to but another restless, disturbed night, because even when he escaped nightmares about Cedric he had unsettling dreams about long dark corridors, all finishing in dead ends and locked doors, which he supposed had something to do with the trapped feeling he had when he was awake (9-10).

The dreams about Cedric are truly nightmares. Harry blames himself for Cedric's murder, which causes the "mental and physical distress" Macrobius requires, and he is worried about Voldemort's return, feeling "anxiety about the future." He listens intently to the news every night, waiting for anything that might indicate Voldemort is beginning to commit murders (9). The dreams about the corridors and doors, however, have no waking impetus. It is not until he goes to the Department of Mysteries that we can be certain they are significant and not merely dreams.

Two of Harry's actual dreams in *Order of the Phoenix* do fit into Macrobius' category of nightmare because they are influenced by worries during his waking hours and because they are not truly prophetic, as Tonks notes: "I suppose it's not really prophecy you're doing, is it? I mean, you're not seeing the future, you're seeing the present....It's odd, isn't it? Useful though" (*OotP* 482). These are the two actual dreams in *Order of the Phoenix*, the dream of Arthur's attack and the dream of Voldemort torturing Sirius. Both are influenced by his worries about the Department of Mysteries, which began as a dream he could not understand but has become a waking concern. They are also influenced by his concern for Arthur and Sirius, because he knows all of the Order are in danger. He has worried since *Goblet of Fire* that Sirius will be found and handed over to the Dementors. Now he worries about all the Order members, especially Sirius, since the Death Eaters are anxious to fight against the Order. So, too, is the Ministry of Magic, which believes the Order is spreading lies by fighting Voldemort, as Umbridge explains on the first day of term: "[Y]ou have been informed that a certain dark

wizard is at large once again. *This is a lie*" (245). The dream which leads Harry to the Hall of Prophecy is anomalous because it neither predicts the future nor shows Harry an actual event. Macrobius acknowledges that nightmares are sometimes "deceitful" (89). This dream of Sirius' interrogation is deceitful, contrived by Voldemort and planted in Harry's mind to draw him into the Hall of Prophecy. They do differ slightly from Macrobius' categorization, though. Macrobius' nightmares "afterwards have no importance or meaning" (89). Harry's nightmares, though not prophetic, are extremely important. Without them, Harry would not be able to see Mr. Weasley's attack or get to the prophecy.

Like the nightmares, all of the medievalisms discussed in this chapter are vital to Harry's defeat of Voldemort. Without his dreams, his semi-conscious visions, and others' memories, Harry would not have all the information he needs to defeat Voldemort. I will examine this necessity more fully in the next chapter, showing that medievalisms create a satisfying ending that appeals to cultural nostalgia.

"EIGHTEEN YEARS LATER": APPEALING TO CULTURAL NOSTALGIA

Nostalgia is an important term in the discussion of medievalism. Medieval authors regarded the Classical world with a sense of cultural nostalgia; Chaucer, for example, set many of his poems in the Classical past. Alice Chandler argues that nostalgia was a driving force behind the medieval revival of the nineteenth century. *Nostalgia* here refers to cultural nostalgia, a yearning for a period in the past which no one living experienced but which is highly romanticized. Victorian medievalists viewed the Middle Ages as a golden time, selectively ignoring any problems. They focused instead on chivalry and romance, painting knights as perfect Victorian gentlemen and serfs as the contented lower class they wished the Victorian working class could be. As Rosemary Jann argues, Victorian medievalism was more a projection of Victorian values onto the Middle Ages than a genuine yearning for the Middle Ages as they were (129). We can see this in such works as Alfred, Lord Tennyson's nearly sexless *Idylls of the King* or Sir Walter Scott's happy serf and fool, Gurth and Wamba, in *Ivanhoe*. Tennyson held very conservative views about sex. In reworking Malory's *Morte Darthur*, he largely bowdlerized the story, removing most references to sexual activity. He does tell the story of Lancelot's and Guinevere's affair, but without directly referencing sex, and he changes part of the story to make Arthur pure. In Malory, Arthur and Morgana beget Modred; in Tennyson, Arthur says to Guinevere, "I was ever virgin save for thee." Scott's serfs seem rather unlikely. Though they are literally bound to serve Cedric, wearing metal collars on their necks, they seem perfectly

content, reflecting the medievalist conviction that all participants in the feudal system had been content and that, if given a greater sense of purpose through the restoration of feudalism, the working class (who would become serfs and fools) would be happy. To the nineteenth-century medievalist, medieval peasants had lived a healthier, better life than members of the industrial working class. Comparing feudal laborers to "the industrial proletariat, working an eighty-four hour week in lint-choked factories and living in sickness-breeding, filthy hovels...even a thirteenth-century serf was fortunate" (3). Beyond the condition of workers, these medievalists bemoaned the loss of a unified society. They saw a community- and family-centered society in feudalism.

Christopher Shaw and Malcolm Chase suggest that the prevalence of nostalgic images in contemporary European culture is "a symptom of contemporary malaise. The sick man of Europe had taken to his bed, dreaming of a childhood he had never had" (1). Indeed, I believe Rowling's series does react to a type of malaise, or at least despair, but she responds to this differently than nineteenth-century medievalists did. Nineteenth-century medieval texts are usually set in the Middle Ages; *Harry Potter* is set in the 1980s and 1990s. Rather than conspicuously invoking medievalism through medieval plot and setting, appealing to nostalgia by projecting modern ideas back on to the Middle Ages, Rowling recreates World War II and, by using medievalism — the visions — paints post-World War II Britain in a more positive light. What medievalist texts do, and what I argue *Harry Potter* does, is consciously react to a sense of cultural discontent and nostalgia, soothing the discontent and appealing to this nostalgia by using medievalisms to create a satisfying ending. This ending may not be specifically happy, but it has a restored equilibrium, one in which the best modern values have won. The *Potter* series does the same thing. Harry's

visions and others' memories are medievalisms because of their formal similarities to Chaucer's dream visions and also because personal nostalgia is important to them, as it is to Chaucer's visions. I then examine the connection between dream visions and cultural nostalgia. Chaucer's dream visions clearly show a sense of longing for the Classical age. Cultural nostalgia was a major part of the nineteenth-century medieval revival and therefore is a key part of the medievalist tradition. Finally, I show that *Harry Potter* is part of this tradition because Harry's defeat of Voldemort responds to modern British cultural nostalgia.

First, I establish the role of cultural nostalgia in Chaucer's dream visions. This sense is particularly strong in the *Book of the Duchess*. Chaucer's narrator describes Ovid's *Metamorphoses* with a nostalgic nod toward the Classical period, referring to it as the time when "men loved the lawe of kind" (56). This seems to indicate that the Classical era was a time of kindness and lawfulness; the explanatory note suggests that this phrase "implies the gentle dealings between people in the unbrutalized Golden Age" (Wilcockson 967). That Chaucer is referring back to this "old tyme" (53) when people were kind indicates a contrast between that time and the medieval period. The impression, then, is that the narrator is nostalgic for this kindler, gentler Classical period. Since Chaucer (and, by extensions, his narrator) could not have remembered the Classical age, not having lived then, this is an example of cultural, not personal nostalgia.

The *Book of the Duchess* was probably written as a commemorative poem marking the death of John of Gaunt's wife, Blanche, Duchess of Lancaster (Wilcockson 329). John of Gaunt was a significant public figure, a wealthy duke, so it does not seem unlikely that Blanche's death would have caused some degree of societal distress. There were annual observances of Blanche's

death, for which John of Guant may have commissioned Chaucer to write the poem (Wilcockson 329; Crow and Leland xv). A further indication that Chaucer may have responded to some cultural distress is his probable use of Guillaume de Machaut's *Jugement dou Roy de Navarre* as a source text. The *Navarre* opens with a description of the Black Death, the cause of Blanche's death (Wilcockson 329-30). The plague did not, of course, only kill aristocrats, and it caused suffering throughout Europe. Wilcockson suggests that, in quoting from the *Navarre*, Chaucer may have been reminding his audience of the Black Death. In writing a poem responding to two possible causes of societal distress, Chaucer, in writing the *Book of the Duchess*, appeals to cultural nostalgia, for a time before both Blanche's death and the bubonic plague.

Cultural nostalgia was also important to the medieval revival of the nineteenth century. In the introduction to *A Dream of Order*, Alice Chandler describes the extent to which the medieval revival was a reaction to an ever-changing present. The initial rise of medievalism was in the Elizabethan period, when religious and political radicals used the Middle Ages to defend their ideas. In the seventeenth century and after, however, medievalism was a nostalgic look at England as it had been before these Elizabethan changes:

The more the world changed, and the period of the medieval revival was an era of ever accelerating social transformation, the more the partly historical but basically mythical Middle Ages that had become a tradition in literature served to remind men of a Golden Age. The Middle Ages were idealized as a period of faith, order, joy, munificence, and creativity (1).

The Civil War in particular inspired a reverence for the past as Britons found a renewed interest in now imperiled medieval buildings and long-gone practices and ideals. This revival had its

peak in the nineteenth century, as the first Industrial Revolution "had created a very obvious nostalgia for the past" (2).

Although they waxed nostalgic for feudal society, Victorian medievalists still feared a social revolution. Many shared Marx's thought that society had lost "the motley feudal ties that bound man to his *natural superiors*" (qtd. in Chandler 4). All these societal views had their base in a cynical worldview that saw man as "a fallible, selfish creature, dominated by emotion rather than reason, and prone to weakness, error, and greed." By reviving medieval social structures, medievalist writers believed, man could be a bit more controlled by putting his flawed feelings into pageantry. Throughout the medievalist, anti-utilitarian sphere, but especially to members of the Young England party, the idea persisted that the powerful are obligated to assist the poor (5-6).

To show that Rowling is part of this tradition, I clarify that the visions and memories enable Harry to defeat Voldemort. Not only do these visions help Harry save lives, they also contribute to his ability to defeat Voldemort. One of the major plot points of *Half-Blood Prince* is Harry and Dumbledore's "lessons," as Dumbledore calls them, in which they use Dumbledore's Pensieve to view memories about to view memories about Voldemort. Dumbledore has suspected since the end of Harry's second year that Voldemort had created Horcruxes (*HBP* 500), and the memory Harry secures from Slughorn confirms this. Though they do not provide conclusive proof that Voldemort made Horcruxes, the other memories are just as important because they help Harry to know what the unidentified Horcruxes might be. Remembering Borgin's and Hokey's memories, Harry is able to guess that Slytherin's locket and Hufflepuff's cup might be Horcruxes (*HBP* 505). Nearly a year later, Harry relies on having seen Hokey's memory. Having

broken into the Lestranges' vault at Gringotts, Harry, Ron, and Hermione need to find Hufflepuff's cup quickly. Remembering what he saw in the Pensieve, Harry tells them that "the cup's small and gold, it's got a badger engraved on it, two handles" (*DH* 538). Without seeing Hokey's memory, Harry would not have been able to describe the cup carefully, nor might he have been able to identify it. Having seen all of the memories, Harry is able to have a better idea of how Voldemort thinks, which helps him to try to determine what the sixth Horcrux might be. Although only Slughorn's memory confirms that Voldemort made Horcruxes, they all give Harry information he needs to destroy the Horcruxes.

At the beginning of *Deathly Hallows*, Harry believes destroying the Horcruxes is all he must do to defeat Voldemort. Once he hears the *Tale of the Three Brothers*, however, he begins to wonder: "Was this the answer? Hallows versus Horcruxes?" (429). Through the visions, he realizes that he must destroy all of the Horcruxes and be master of the Hallows to truly defeat Voldemort. When Harry sees Voldemort steal the Elder Wand from Dumbledore's tomb (501), he believes that Voldemort, too, is seeking to unite the Hallows. It is after this visions, though, that Harry sees Voldemort checking that his Horcruxes are safe, which tells him that the Horcruxes are still important. Because of all these visions, he knows that he must personally destroy the Horcruxes or ensure that they will be destroyed if he dies, and he knows that when he goes to sacrifice himself, he must have both the Invisibility Cloak and the Resurrection Stone with him. It is through Snape's memories that Harry learns he must allow himself to be killed so that Voldemort can be killed.

Harry's defeat of Voldemort allows the series to appeal to cultural nostalgia. I argue that this nostalgia is a reaction not industrialization but to the political climate of post-World War II Britain. Rowling has constructed a redeemed England, one made more positive through the selective memory of nostalgia. The fight between the good wizards (the Order of the Phoenix, Dumbledore's Army, and all their allies) and the Death Eaters is an extended metaphor for World War II. Voldemort is a Hitler-figure, determined to rid the world of a group of people he sees as "impure," even though his father belonged to that group of people. In this series, Muggles represent Jews. Muggle-born and half-blood witches and wizards are equally persecuted, as Europeans with only some Jewish ancestry were persecuted during the Holocaust. As some Gentiles did, Snatchers turn in Muggle-borns and half-bloods not because they support Voldemort but in order to receive a cash reward.

Britain in and after World War II is represented by two groups of people: the Muggle world, and the good wizards. The Muggle world, of course, is the real-world modern Britain that British readers actually inhabit, a world the Wizarding world opposes and makes seem carefree. If the fight represents World War II, the good wizards more properly represent all of the Allied forces, as international Wizards are involved in the battle, but most of the major players are British, so this group is most adequately a representation of the Britons during World War II. World War II, it sometimes seems, looms over Britain. The country bears visible marks of the Blitz; the British Empire effectively crumpled after 1945. One would not say World War II ended with a clear victory of good over evil. Hitler was defeated, of course, but the Cold War then stretched over the next four decades. Politics within Britain, too, have been dissatisfying to most Britons. *Half-Blood Prince* begins in the summer of 1996, the year before John Major left office,

replaced by Tony Blair. Blair was able to win that election because Major's conservative party had become unpopular. In 1997, 59% of Britons polled were dissatisfied with Major's performance as Prime Minister, 69% were dissatisfied with the government overall⁸ The book was published in June 2005, when only 44% of Britons polled were satisfied with Blair's performance as Prime Minister. This rating was his highest since 2003⁹.

In contrast to a half-century of unsatisfactory political climate, Rowling constructs a version of World War II in which Britain, as represented by the good wizards, clearly wins or, as represented by the Muggles, has no concerns or worries. Yes, the Order sustains heavy losses, with more of its members and allies dying than Death Eaters, but good clearly defeats evil. Rowling's epilogue is neat and tidy — to the chagrin of many fans — and while there is no comment on actual events in the 18 years between Voldemort's defeat and Albus Severus Potter's first year at Hogwarts, the impression is that those years were essentially perfect. Harry married Ginny. Ron married Hermione. Teddy Lupin, though orphaned the night of Voldemort's defeat, seems well cared-for by his godfather Harry. Ron references his father, and there is no indication that Molly is not also alive and well. Neville, finally, was able to realize his full potential and become the Herbology professor at Hogwarts. The final sentence of the series sums up the impression of the Wizarding world after Voldemort's defeat: "All was well" (759). Unlike the real European world after World War II, the Wizarding world, and presumably the Muggle world, after the fantastically symbolized World War II, is worry-free and happy. Rowling's story helps to recover Europe from its "contemporary malaise."

⁸ Ipsos MORI, "MORI Political Monitor March 1997."

⁹ Ibid., "MORI Political Monitor July 2005."

Without visions and memories all could not be well. The memories in *Half-Blood Prince* begin to give Harry the information he needs to destroy the separate bits of Voldemort's soul so that they will both be mortal when they fight to the death. Without his glimpses into Voldemort's mind, he would not be able to find and defeat Voldemort. Because of these medievalisms, the series can end in a satisfactory way. This construction, of medievalism creating a satisfying ending, makes *Harry Potter* part of the medievalist tradition.

FAITHFUL ADAPTATIONS: CONSIDERING THE FILMS

The argument I have made earlier in this thesis lends itself to a similar argument about the films. Others have suggested that the battle of good versus evil is a medievalism and that Harry is a medieval hero, but not that the films are part of the medieval film genre. There is no clear definition of "medieval film"—as Martha W. Driver notes, the term seems to be an oxymoron. The films are generally categorized as part of the fantasy genre. I argue that the films are fantasy but also part of the medieval film genre. Because the film adaptations appeal to culture nostalgia, which is so important to medievalism, and because they contain the visions and memories, medievalisms that are a major factor in Harry's defeat of Voldemort, I argue for the films' inclusion in the genre of medieval film.

The films have many visual indications of medievalism. Many scenes are shot at Oxford. Both Hogwarts castles¹⁰ appear medieval. The castles have suits of armor in their halls and ghosts in clothes many audience members would think of as medieval¹¹. Harry is brave and selfless, seemingly chivalrous. These features would indicate that the series is medieval film, but they are also features common to the entire fantasy genre. Fantasy film and medieval film are connected in that nostalgia is an important feature of both. The nostalgia in each is different, though. Katherine Fowkes cites personal nostalgia as an integral part of the fantasy genre.

¹⁰ Christopher Columbus shot *Sorcerer's Stone* and *Chamber of Secrets* at a different Hogwarts before Alonzo Cuarón changed the location

¹¹ Though they do not seem to be based on the actual designs of medieval clothing Helene Roberts describes (28).

Fantasy often centers on a yearning for one's home or childhood. Indeed, the *Potter* films do indicate such a longing — Ron tells Harry, "Welcome home" upon their arrival at Hogwarts in *Chamber of Secrets*, as he does in the book; and Harry wishes to return to Godric's Hollow, where he sees his childhood home, in *Deathly Hallows Part I*. The films also react to the same cultural nostalgia as the books, and this is a type of nostalgia Fowkes does not discuss.

As discussed earlier, the books recreate World War II. This imagery appears in the films and is particularly strong in *Deathly Hallows Part I*. The Ministry of Magic guards and Snatchers wear uniforms evocative of both German and Italian soldiers. Like Mussolini's troops, they wear black. Like Hitler's, they wear armbands. The Gestapo imagery is strong, reinforcing the books' Holocaust metaphor. This imagery is made even stronger at Malfoy Manor when Bellatrix tortures Hermione for information about the sword of Gryffindor. In the book, Hermione is covered in cuts. In the film, Bellatrix carves the word "Mudblood" into Hermione's forearm. The injury evokes the image of concentration camp prisoner's tattoos, which were alpha-numerical, branded the prisoner as an undesirable member of society, and forced on the prisoner by a guard. Bellatrix is not parallel to a camp guard, but she is a Death Eater, the group comparable to the Gestapo, and she forces the wound on Hermione. The cuts conspicuously brand Hermione as an undesirable witch in Death Eaters' eyes. The cuts are deep enough to drip blood, so the wound is deep enough to scar and become permanent, like a tattoo. Reinforcing the World War II references that are more subtle in the book shows that the film responds to the same nostalgic concerns as the book. Although *Deathly Hallows Part II* may not end exactly as the book does, it seems likely that Harry will defeat Voldemort with the help of his visions.

It is in the nature of film adaptations that some parts of the source texts' narratives will not appear in the films. Many fans of the *Potter* novels complain that the movies remove too much of the storyline. After *Order of the Phoenix* was released in theaters, some complained that Harry and the other D.A. members did not have to battle enough in the Ministry of Magic. They visited only two of the rooms: the Hall of Prophecy and the basin-shaped room in which Bellatrix kills Sirius. The other rooms are significant in the book's larger narrative because the difficulty of getting through them to access the prophecy proves, in part, the prophetic nature of Harry's dreams about the Department of Mysteries. Further, they add excitement to the narrative. The reader is anxious as the teenagers fail to access the Hall of Prophecy and then try to keep the prophecy safe while fighting their way back to the Atrium. This lost excitement is what some viewers bemoaned after seeing the film version. Knowing that the screenwriters jettisoned material — like these Ministry scenes and Harry giving his Triwizard earnings to Fred and George — that is important to the narrative but not vital to the series' conclusion, looking at which scenes did make it to the movie is as interesting as looking at which ones were cut. In this chapter, I am concerned with the inclusion of Harry's dream of Arthur Weasley's attack, because it is not vital to Harry's defeat of Voldemort, as the false dream about Sirius and the semi-conscious visions in *Deathly Hallows* are.

In the books, the dream of Arthur's attack has two immediate results: the Order learns about the attack, and Dumbledore asks Snape to teach Harry Occlumency. These results, in turn, have their own results. Because the Order knows about Arthur's attack, they are able to save him in time and get him to St. Mungo's Hospital for Magical Maladies and Injuries. At St. Mungo's, Harry learns that some of the Order believe Voldemort is possessing him. With Ron and

Hermione, he also sees Gilderoy Lockhart and Neville Longbottom's parents. The scene with Neville, his grandmother, and his parents is significant because it is one of the few instances in which the audience is consciously aware of the Death Eaters' impact. It also underscores Bellatrix's evil nature and the similarities between Harry and Neville.

Harry's Occlumency lessons make one of the last three books' most important plot points. Emotionally, they enhance Harry's and Snape's mutual hatred, making Snape's memories and Harry's forgiveness in *Deathly Hallows* more poignant. They also lead to Harry's realization that his father was a bit of a bully, which is a difficult emotional moment for Harry. Beyond the emotional impact, the Occlumency lessons allow for other events to occur, and they remain important in books six and seven. Throughout *Order of the Phoenix*, Harry struggles with Snape's instruction to close his mind before going to sleep each night. Ron and Hermione, especially the latter, check his progress in this area and encourage him to keep practicing Occlumency. The impression from Dumbledore is that, if Harry had learned Occlumency, he never would have dreamed that Voldemort was torturing Sirius¹². In *Half-Blood Prince*, Harry learns that Bellatrix has been teaching Draco Occlumency. In *Deathly Hallows*, Hermione admonishes Harry for having the visions, telling him again that he must close his mind. The impact of Occlumency is significant, and Harry's failure to learn it is as important as the audience's knowledge of the subject's existence. If Harry had learned Occlumency, he would not have had the visions that enable him to defeat Voldemort.

Knowing that the screenwriters generally restrict the adaptation to those points which have the largest bearing on the narrative, one might wonder why they kept Harry's dream of

¹² Dumbledore claims that, had he given Harry the lessons, Harry might have been able to successfully close his mind and therefore never have seen the false dream.

Arthur's attack. They did not keep any of the scenes at St. Mungo's, so the fact that Arthur was injured is of no narrative or emotional importance; in fact, it seems to be an after-thought. Arthur returns to Grimmauld Place on Christmas Day, all present cheer, and Arthur toasts Harry for saving his life. Sirius then calls Harry away. That Arthur was attacked seems almost irrelevant. The importance, it seems, is that Harry had the dream, although no one discusses this significance, as they do in the book. Snape does give Harry Occlumency lessons in the film, but they do not carry the same importance. Hermione and Ron never ask him about the lessons, and we never see any indication that he is trying — much less struggling — to close his mind. He does not seem disturbed by Snape's memory of being tortured by James, and Dumbledore does not indicate that Harry's failure to learn Occlumency caused the false dream. Snape and Draco do not discuss Occlumency in the *Half-Blood Prince* film, and Hermione does not exhort Harry to close his mind in *Deathly Hallows Part I*. She says, sharply, that the visions and the pain in Harry's scar should have stopped, but she then leaves the topic of Occlumency. The dream of Arthur's attack is of no lasting significance, but it is still in the film. The inclusion of this medievalism, the dream, is part of the film's inclusion in the medieval film genre.

The inclusion of a dream, even though it is not given lasting significance, is important. More important is the faithful adaptation of the dreams, visions, and memories. They are perhaps the most faithful adaptations in the films, which tend to differ significantly from the novels. Because the visions are so faithfully adapted, they remain medievalisms. Harry is always distressed before the visions, especially in *Deathly Hallows Part I*. The film series is not yet complete, and there is no guarantee that the visions' relationship to the past and future will turn out to have been the same as it was in the books. However, Dumbledore does say at the end of

the *Order of the Phoenix* film that he has long suspected a connection between Harry's and Voldemort's minds. This, combined with the faithful adaptation of the visions, indicates that Snape's memories in *Deathly Hallows Part II* will show, as they do in the book, that Harry's visions are possible because of the prophecy and Voldemort's attack, and that the visions will be an integral part of Harry's ability to defeat Voldemort.

Writing about the films is problematic because the final film has not yet been released. Because of this, I must make some assumptions, but they are assumptions based on the previous films. Because the films faithfully adapt the visions, and because Dumbledore references his prior knowledge of Harry's and Voldemort's mental connection, it seems likely that *Deathly Hallows Part II* will show Dumbledore explaining that the prophecy and Voldemort's attack are the reason Harry is able to have the visions. The adaptations are very deliberate, and J.K. Rowling has a great influence over and say in the adaptations. As she and Steve Kloves explain in an interview on the *Chamber of Secrets* DVD, the two share a close friendship. Before changing a scene, Kloves would speak to Rowling to ensure that his desired change would not pose a problem for later major events. Because so many of the visions from the book made it into the *Order of the Phoenix* and *Deathly Hallows Part I* films, it seems likely that they will be a major reason Harry is able to defeat Voldemort. The films, then, will have responded to the same cultural nostalgia as the books using the same appeal: that of carefully adapted medievalisms in the dreams, visions, and memories.

CONCLUSION

A major difference between Chaucer's and Rowling's dream visions is the effect on the dreamer. In Rowling's text, the visions and memories allow all to be well. In Chaucer, a dream vision's ending is more emotionally ambiguous. The *House of Fame*, because it is unfinished, does not have this type of ambiguous ending¹³, but both the *Book of the Duchess* and the *Parliament* do. Neither narrator can say that the dream has actually brought him any kind of ease. The *Book of the Duchess*' narrator obviously was able to sleep, because he did dream, but the cause of his insomnia remains unidentified and, presumably, uncured. The *Parliament's* ending is inconclusive, with the dreamer turning again to books in the hope that one day he will find something to ease him. The visions do not end on an explicitly pessimistic note, but they do not indicate definite optimism, and they certainly do not allow all to be well.

These inconclusive endings, especially the *Parliament's*, are critical cruxes in Chaucer scholarship, in part because the prologues of dream visions tend to be somewhat hopeful, with a dreamer who seems to think he can find what he needs to be eased. The ambiguous endings mark a departure from tradition. Earlier dream visions, such as Jean de Meun's *Romance of the Rose* and Boethius' *Consolation of Philosophy*¹⁴, have more conclusively happy endings. In the former, the dreamer wins the rose; in the latter, Boethius learns to take full comfort in Lady Philosophy's

¹³ Its ending is ambiguous in its own way, however, precisely because it is unfinished. Critics debate whether Chaucer intended to leave the poem unfinished, and they debate the identity of the "man of gret auctorite" (2158).

¹⁴ Whether or not the *Consolation* is truly a dream vision is still another point of critical debate. I include it here because it does contain elements of the vision, especially the distressed narrator, and because Philosophy's appearance to Boethius is dream-like, especially in her changing size (4).

words. In giving his visions vague endings, Chaucer shows a certain hesitancy to accept the traditional dream form. This hesitancy is shown even more explicitly in the prologue to the *House of Fame*. The Geoffrey of that poem seems to reject dream theory altogether, saying that he "certainly" can neither understand dream divination nor busy his mind understanding the types and significances of different causes of dreams, "[a]s yf folkys complexions/ Make hem dreme of reflexions" (14-22). These lines indicate more than a failure to comprehend. In saying "certainly" and "as if," Chaucer takes on a sarcastic and somewhat disdainful tone. Further, "as if" seems to mean "as if anyone can really believe" that the humors influence one's dreams. Chaucer gladly participates in the tradition of the dream vision, but he does not seem to accept all of its tropes and assumptions without question.

This questioning can be further seen in Chaucer's use of source texts, whose moral and philosophical injunctions he sometimes questions. One of the source texts of the *Book of the Duchess* is the *Jugement dou Roy de Behaingne*, which argues that an unfaithful spouse is a much greater cause for grief than a deceased spouse (Wilcockson 329). Chaucer does not write about a knight whose lover had betrayed him; he consoles John of Gaunt by writing a poem that confirms the extreme distress of becoming a widower, an adaptation which contradicts the source text. One can see this type of contradiction in the *Parliament*, as well. This narrator questions Macrobius, refusing to take him at his word. According to Macrobius, one's daytime concerns and activities influence one's dreams. This narrator says that he is not certain reading the *Dream of Scipio* caused him to dream of Scipio the Elder, which indicates that he has doubts about Macrobius' formulations. Reading a text and then dreaming about it, this narrator seems to say, might be just a coincidence.

Although Chaucer shows skepticism about the dream vision form, Rowling's use of it in the *Harry Potter* series still makes Harry's visions medievalisms. Chaucer's skepticism might make his texts a rather shaky support for the argument that visions are memories in Rowling's texts are medievalisms. Despite this, my argument has potential. Like Chaucer, Rowling takes liberties with the dream vision form. In so doing, she shows part of her "engagement with the Middle Ages," one of Workman's requirements for medievalism — and, because I use his conception of medievalism, one of my own requirements.

Rowling's engagement with medieval texts, of course, goes beyond the visions and memories, and a lengthier study would examine all of these other instances of medievalism. Unlike the visions and memories, these other medievalisms first appear in *Sorcerer's Stone*¹⁵. There are, of course, visual medievalisms, such as the castle and the ghosts, who were alive during the Middle Ages.¹⁶ This thesis, though, has endeavored to discuss medievalism that is textual, rather than visual. The visions and memories cannot look medieval, because they all occur in the twentieth century, but they are textually medievalisms because of their parallels to Chaucer and Macrobius. In a broader study, one could examine several other instances of non-visual medievalisms.

Throughout the series, but especially in *Chamber of Secrets* and *Deathly Hallows*, much is made of the connection between one's personality and one's school house, represented by colors and animals. This implies a connection between one's character and a color or an animal.

¹⁵ Though Harry's visions do not appear until *Order of the Phoenix*, Rowling begins building towards this plot point in *Sorcerer's Stone*. When Harry first sees Snape at the Sorting, his scar hurts. This becomes common in *Goblet of Fire* and, by *Deathly Hallows*, heralds every vision. In discussing earlier instances of visions, one might analyze the Mirror of Erised, as Susan Reynolds has done, or the memory of Riddle preserved in the diary Harry and Ginny find in *Chamber of Secrets*.

¹⁶ I call these visual medievalisms because they look as audiences likely believe medieval castles and medieval people looked, but they have no clear connection to tropes from medieval literature, as textual medievalisms do.

The connection between colors and personality might be examined in the context of humoral theory, because the humors influence temperament and house membership is influenced by one's temperament. The connection between animals and personality might also be seen as a medievalism. Gail Orgelfinger's article "J.K. Rowling's Medieval Bestiary" suggests parallels between *Harry Potter* and the medieval bestiaries. She discusses the house animals, especially Gryffindor's lion and Slytherin's serpent, in her examination. This discussion could be expanded upon, as the animals in the bestiaries represented different types of character and behavior. The idea that one's character is best represented by either a raven, a badger, a lion, or a serpent, therefore, is one of the series' earliest examples of medievalism. Orgelfinger's connection of Rowling's text and the bestiaries is engaging, and a reading of house membership specifically in comparison to the bestiaries would be in comfortable conversation with her article.

As Orgelfinger explains, the bestiaries were essentially books of morality that used animals as allegories for proper and improper Christian behavior. Reading the series in terms of the bestiary would also open a space for considering Christian themes in the series — a topic hotly debated in some circles, as there are those who oppose the series on religious grounds and others who defend it on the same grounds. Some of the latter have used animal imagery to defend this reading. One could argue that Harry is resurrected and therefore a Christ-figure. The text clearly quotes the Bible on Kendra Dumbledore's and Lily and James Potters' tombstones: "Where your treasure is, there will your heart be also" (Matt. 6:21, Luk. 12:34) and "The last enemy that shall be destroyed is death" (1 Cr. 15:26), respectively (*DH* 325 and 328).

These Christian references, both overt and allegorical, coexist seamlessly with Pagan references. Sybil Trelawney's name evokes Classical soothsayers, Minerva McGonagall shares

her name with the Roman goddess of wisdom, and Remus Lupin's first name comes from one of the mythical founders of Rome. Magic itself, which is obviously important to the series, has a tenuous relationship with Christianity, as does astrology. Astrology plays a significant role in the narrative. The centaurs predict the future using astrology, and it is one of the methods Trelawney uses in practicing Divination, though Firenze indicates that human astrology is different from and less precise than centaur astrology. Several characters, such as Sirius Black, Andromeda Tonks, and Bellatrix Lestrange share their names with constellations.

This coexistence of Pagan and Christian figures and references occurs frequently in Chaucer's works, as well. For example, the *House of Fame* invokes the Christian God in the first two lines. The dream, though, is rich with Classical imagery, notably the scenes from the Aeneid on the temple walls. The narrator in the *Book of the Duchess* indicates that he practices Christianity (237), but he prays that Juno will help him sleep (238-269). The first quotation in the *Parliament* seems Christian: "God save swich a lord!", but the garden in the dream is filled with images of Classical figures, and Nature presides over the parliament.

Harry Potter is rooted in rich literary traditions, and there are more medievalisms in the text than the two examined in this thesis. An examination of all of them, however, far exceeds the parameters of this project. Here I have endeavored to show one aspect of Rowling's place in the tradition of British literature. By engaging with medieval texts, Rowling inserts herself into the tradition of medievalism. That tradition is invested in responding to cultural sentiment and offering moral principles. In participating in this tradition, Rowling does what Safire has argued she cannot: she has made her text appropriate for both child and adult audiences.

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